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Senior Developer

Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office

Apply before 11:55 pm on Monday 6th July 2026



Foreign, Commonwealth
& Development Office

Reference number

436894

Salary

£46,000

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Senior Executive Officer

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Full-time

Number of jobs available

2

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Location

You will be required to work from this location in line with FCDO policies on Hybrid Working (minimum 60% in the office).

About the job

Job summary

The Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office pursues our national interests and projects the UK's role in the world. We promote the interests of British citizens, safeguard the UK's security, defend our values, reduce poverty and tackle global challenges with our international partners. We employ more than 17,000 staff in 179 countries and territories, across our diplomatic and development offices worldwide, which consists of 282 officially designated Posts. Our UK-based staff work in King Charles Street, London, Abercrombie House in East Kilbride and in Milton Keynes.

Digital, Technology and Security Directorate (DTaS) is responsible for delivering the Foreign Secretary's ambition to make the FCDO the most technologically integrated and innovative foreign ministry globally. This means harnessing digital, data, technology, IT security and information management to support the FCDO and UK Government partners on our platform to deliver our diplomatic, development and consular aims. All while keeping our people and information safe, especially from hostile actors.

The work we do is varied – from historical analysis and library services to cyber protection, from information rights to global network management, from supporting staff in using the latest Microsoft toolsets, to creating corporate applications, harnessing AI and much more in line with the FCDO Digital, Data and Technology (DDaT) Strategy.

The Directorate is made up of a wide range of talented staff and experts including specialist, contractors, home civil servants and diplomats who have served overseas.

Job description

Main Purpose of Job

The role is both exciting and challenging. As we expand our product function, we are developing a wide range of new digital products that will transform how the organisation operates. In this position, you will help lead the development of these products and play a key role in shaping our overall approach to product delivery. You will work across a portfolio of digital products and services that support the FCDO in delivering its development and diplomacy goals, including tools that assist diplomats working in Embassies overseas.

We design and build these products in-house using a multidisciplinary, full-stack development team. Our work is international, diverse and highly collaborative. We are looking for people who are motivated by making a meaningful impact, passionate about creating user-focused services, and who enjoy working in a modern, agile environment using contemporary tools and practices.

As a Senior Developer, you will design, run, and improve software that meets user needs. In this role you are responsible for writing clean, secure code following a test-driven approach and creating code that is easy for others to reuse. You will also be responsible for coaching and mentoring colleagues in the software development profession to develop their skills and capability.

Roles and Responsibilities

The successful candidate will:

- Plan and lead development across sets of related user stories.

- Understand the end-to-end system and help others build that understanding.

- Work closely with colleagues across disciplines to define and deliver what needs to be built.

- Coach and mentor more junior developers.

- Operate and support the production services you create.

- Identify and implement improvements that enhance system robustness, resilience and stability.

Contribute to innovative projects, for example our **Power Platform Centre of Excellence** and play a key role in the development and delivery of robust, scalable Power Platform solutions.

For **Programme Delivery**, we work with a modern technology stack designed to support high-quality, secure, and scalable development. As part of our team, you will use:

Programming Languages: C#, JavaScript

Developer Platform: .Net and .Net Framework

IDE: Visual Studio

Version Control: Git

Sprint management and release pipelines: Azure DevOps

Database: SQL Server

Playwright for end-to-end testing

There will occasionally be the opportunity to travel within the UK, or to overseas offices, to support product development, but this is not mandatory.

Person specification

You must be a British Citizen at the time of application and, if invited to interview, you will need to bring proof of identity (British Passport/Driving Licence etc.) with you.

This role requires you to attain Developed Vetting (DV) security clearance.

For more information about this process, [click here](#). Attaining DV will require you to have been resident in the UK for five of the last ten years. At least one year of this must have been a consecutive twelve-month period. Serving overseas with HM Forces, in some other official capacity as a representative of His Majesty's Government or having lived overseas as a result of your parents' or partner's Government employment counts as UK residency for the purposes of security clearances.

It is essential in your application that you provide evidence and proven examples in each of the following Minimum Criteria, the Behaviours and

the Technical question as far as you are able to do so. These responses will be further developed and discussed with those candidates invited for interview.

Essential Criteria

Programming and Build (Practitioner) Ability to collaborate with others, when necessary, to review specifications and use agreed specifications to design, code, test and document medium to high complexity programs. This includes ensuring successful delivery whilst maintaining architectural and coding standards and application security demands.

Systems Design (Practitioner) Ability to competently apply modern development standards and guide others to do so, using your knowledge of clean architecture and good software design concepts and design patterns to ensure that software developed is consistent, reliable and efficient.

Modern Development Standards: (Practitioner) Ability to write robust, reusable code that is well tested and easy to maintain, ensuring that any coding standards and secure coding is maintained throughout the codebase. Ensuring that code has adequate unit testing and that definition of done practices are followed.

User Focus (Practitioner) - Comprehensive understanding of user needs to develop a detailed grasp of the problems to be solved. Able to work as part of a multi-disciplinary team alongside others to ensure that users are at the core of all products and that delivering value to them is key.

For more details on the Technical skills above see [Senior Developer](#).

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Working Together

Changing and Improving

Making Effective Decisions

We only ask for evidence of these behaviours on your application form:

Working Together

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Programming and Build (software engineering) - Practitioner Level

Modern Development Standards - Practitioner Level

User Focus Practitioner level

Information Security - Practitioner Level

We only ask for evidence of these technical skills on your application form:

Programming and Build (software engineering) - Practitioner Level

Modern Development Standards - Practitioner Level

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £46,000, Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office contributes £13,326 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides.](#)

A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

25 days Annual Leave per annum.

9 days Public and Privilege holidays per annum.

Learning and Development tailored to your role.

See the attached candidate pack.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has

been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

This vacancy uses the **Success Profiles Framework** to assess your Behaviours and the Senior Developer Framework to assess your Technical skills at Application and Interview stages.

Please see the [Hints and Tips](#) that are provided for your information about how to prepare Behaviour examples at the Application and/or Interview stage.

Application Stage

You will be required to complete the following as part of the online application:

A CV detailing your career history (including any relevant qualifications). CVs will be assessed against the Essential Criteria outlined in the Person Specification section below.

A Personal Statement of 500 words explaining how you consider your skills, qualities and experience provide evidence of your suitability for the role, with specific reference to the Essential Criteria. These responses will be explored further during the interview process for shortlisted candidates.

A Behaviour example of 250 words: Working Together

2 Technical Skills examples: Programming and Build (software engineering) - Practitioner Level; Modern Development Standards - Practitioner Level

IMPORTANT: If you are applying under the Disability Confident Scheme and require Reasonable Adjustments in order to complete your application,

please ensure Government Recruitment Service (GRS) are aware of this on the date of application and certainly by the closing date.

In the event of a large number of applications, we may conduct an initial sift by a lead technical skill alongside your CV and personal statement. For this campaign we will be prioritising **Programming and Build**. Only candidates who meet the minimum standard in this Technical skill will have the rest of their application fully assessed.

Interview Stage

At the start of your interview, you will also be asked a non-assessed warm-up question about your motivation for applying for the role.

Candidates will be required to give a Presentation at the Interview, and the topic will be sent to you in advance. The Presentation will test the following Technical skill:

Systems Design (Practitioner Level)

You will also be assessed on the following Behaviours and Technical skills at Interview:

Behaviours: Changing and Improving; Making effective Decisions

Technical Skills: Programming and Build (software engineering)

Practitioner level; User Focus Practitioner level; Information Security -
Practitioner Level

The FCDO has appointed the Government Recruitment Service to manage the process.

Please see the timeline in the candidate pack attached for indicative dates.

If you are successful at the application stage, you will be invited to attend a panel interview at the Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office. This will be held remotely on Microsoft Teams and details will be given to candidates who are successful at the sift stage.

Reasonable Adjustment

If a person with disabilities is put at a substantial disadvantage compared to a non-disabled person, we have a duty to make reasonable changes to our processes.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should:

Contact Government Recruitment Service via fcdorecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk as soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Complete the Assistance required section in the Additional requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need further on in the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at interview, or if you're deaf, a Language Service Professional.

Further Information

A reserve list may be held for a period of 12 months from which further appointments can be made.

Any move to FCDO from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at <https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk>

New entrants are expected to join on the minimum of the pay band.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant's details held on the IFD will be refused employment.

A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5 year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

If you are experiencing accessibility problems reading the Candidate Pack, such as through screen reader software, please contact our Team via fcdoemployment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk and we will share a Word version of this.

If successful and transferring from another Government Department a criminal record check may be carried out.

In order to process applications without delay, we will be sending a Criminal Record Check to Disclosure Scotland on your behalf.

For further information on the Disclosure Scotland confidential checking service telephone: the Disclosure Scotland Helpline on 0870 609 6006 and ask to speak to the operations manager in confidence, or email Info@disclosurescotland.co.uk

This role is full time only. Applicants who wish to work an alternative pattern are welcome to apply however your preferred working pattern may not be available and you should discuss this with the vacancy holder before applying.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [developed vetting \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

Open to UK nationals only.

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : FCDO Recruitment Team

Email : fcdorecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : fcdorecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Further information

The FCDO's recruitment processes are underpinned by the principle of selection for appointment on merit, on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission Recruitment Principles. If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should, in the first instance, contact External.Recruitment@fcdo.gov.uk. If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the FCDO, you can contact the Office of the Civil Service Commissioners.

